# AI Engineer

Brightwater Systems · Austin, TX (Hybrid, 3 days in office) · Full-time · Engineering – Applied AI

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| **Level** | Early career (1–3 years of experience) |
| **Reports to** | Engineering Manager, Applied AI |
| **Team** | Applied AI (6 engineers, 1 product manager, 1 designer) |

## About Brightwater

Brightwater Systems builds software that helps regional insurers process claims faster. Our platform reads claim documents, answers adjusters' questions and flags unusual claims for review. We are a 120-person company backed by a Series B and serve 40 insurance carriers across the US.

## About the role

As an AI Engineer on the Applied AI team, you will build and ship features that use large language models on top of our claims data. You will own well-defined components end to end, such as a retrieval pipeline or an evaluation harness, working closely with a senior engineer on design and with product and data partners on what to build.

## What you'll do

- Build and maintain retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) pipelines that answer adjusters' questions from claim files, policy documents and notes.
- Design evaluation sets and automated checks for answer correctness and groundedness, and run them on every prompt or model change.
- Ship model-backed features behind APIs (Python, FastAPI) and deploy them to our AWS environment with monitoring for latency, cost and failures.
- Improve quality and cost: caching, prompt and retrieval tuning, and routing simple requests to smaller models.
- Partner with product, design and the claims operations team to turn adjuster feedback into model and product improvements.
- Write clear design notes and share what you learn with the wider engineering team.

## Minimum qualifications

- 1+ years of professional experience building software with Python (internships count toward this).
- Hands-on experience building applications on large language models: prompting, structured output and tool use.
- Experience with retrieval: embeddings, chunking and vector search.
- Understanding of machine learning fundamentals: train/test splits, overfitting and evaluation metrics.
- Experience building and consuming REST APIs.
- Working knowledge of Git and code review.
- Ability to explain technical trade-offs clearly to non-engineers.

## Preferred qualifications

- Experience with vector databases (pgvector, Pinecone or Weaviate).
- Experience with PyTorch and Hugging Face, including fine-tuning small models (e.g. LoRA).
- Experience with LLM orchestration frameworks such as LangChain or LangGraph.

- Cloud experience: AWS (SageMaker, Bedrock) or GCP (Vertex AI).
- Docker and basic CI/CD.
- Hyperparameter tuning (Bayesian, grid or random search) and experiment tracking.
- A cloud ML certification, such as AWS Certified Machine Learning Engineer – Associate or Google Cloud Professional Machine Learning Engineer.
- Experience with insurance, healthcare or other document-heavy domains.

## What success looks like

- **In 3 months:** you have shipped an improvement to our claims Q&A pipeline and added it to the evaluation suite.
- **In 6 months:** you own a component in production (for example the document retrieval service) and have measurably improved its answer quality or cost.
- **In 12 months:** you lead the design of a new model-backed feature with product and claims operations, from evaluation plan to launch.

## What we offer

- Salary range $115,000–$140,000 plus equity.
- Medical, dental and vision coverage; 401(k) with 4% match.
- Flexible time off and 12 company holidays.
- $1,500 yearly learning budget for courses, books and conferences.

## How to apply

Apply with your resume and, if you have them, links to GitHub, a portfolio or a short demo of something you built. We review every application and aim to reply within 10 business days.

Brightwater Systems is an equal opportunity employer. We do not discriminate on the basis of race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, age, disability, veteran status or any other protected characteristic.

Fictional job description created for testing the RightStaff demo. Brightwater Systems is not a real company.